Teo Mendoza

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Portfolio - teomendoza.github.io

Education

Willamette University *Expected Graduation: Fall 2026*
B.S. in Computer Science
GPA: 3.94

Projects

Birthright – 1v1 Online Card Battler

- Designed and developed a competitive 1v1 strategy card game emphasizing tempo, commitment, and reading opponent intent over chance-driven outcomes, built on the principle that every advantage carries a cost.
- Built the game around a low power creep philosophy with card costs capped at 1–5 gold, gold resetting every turn instead of accumulating, and utility scaling with cost instead of raw stats, so no single card or turn can overwhelm the game on its own.
- Layered units, spells, traits, and abilities into a deep toolkit that rewards planning and setup, where every unit commits to attacking, defending, or its own utility each turn and non-regenerating defense makes keeping key units alive an ongoing strategic investment.
- Implemented a server-authoritative multiplayer architecture in Rust on SpacetimeDB, with a Godot and C# client, to keep both players' game state synchronized in real time.
- Released the game publicly on itch.io, growing an early playerbase to 50 players and counting through iterative updates and player feedback.

Work Experience

Contract Game Developer - KHV Games May 2026 – August 2026

- Served as sole backend developer on a 3-person team building an online RPG, architecting foundational systems through data-driven frameworks (procedural world generation, inventory/item systems) that the rest of the team built content on.
- Built a modular enemy AI framework (attack patterns, movement behaviors, targeting logic) that teammates used to design and implement unique enemy identities.
- Implemented client-server synchronization for real-time multiplayer state under a server-authoritative model, and built foundational anti-cheat detection to validate client actions server-side.

Pedalogical – Project Manager & Backend Developer May 2025 – August 2025

- Led a 3 person team developing Pedalogical, an NSF-funded education platform deployed across multiple university courses, supporting 150 students.
- Drove product direction and development by translating research goals into structured system designs, feature roadmaps, and implementation cycles.
- Designed and implemented backend systems for analytics, interaction logging, and AI-driven feedback pipelines, shaping how student behavior is used to guide learning outcomes.

Resident Advisor – Willamette University August 2024 – May 2025

- Supervised a community of 50 residents and collaborated with staff to support a housing population of 600+ students.
- Mediated conflicts, enforced university policies, and responded to crises to maintain a safe and structured living environment.
- Planned and led weekly programs and large-scale monthly events to foster community engagement and student well-being.

Skills

Game Design: Multiplayer Game Design, Combat & Ability Design, Card Design, Economy Design
Backend Engineering: Server-Authoritative Architecture, Systems Design, Multiplayer Networking
Programming: Rust, C#, SQL, Python, GDScript, Bash
Tools: Unity, Godot, SpacetimeDB, Docker, Git/GitHub, PostgreSQL

Publications

Mendoza, T., et al. (2025). *Not All Chatbots Teach: Evidence for Pedagogical Design in AI-Assisted Technical Education.* ACM SIGCITE 2025.